

MODULE 4 · GEMINI NOTEBOOK

Gemini Notebook

Teaching guide: your own sources, cited answers, summaries and audio for studying and working

Module 4
IALab · Edutechlife

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Teaching guide

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Gemini Notebook is a research notebook that answers **only from your sources** and cites where each answer comes from. It is ideal for studying, synthesizing documents and turning long material into summaries, mind maps, study cards and audio.

Jul 16	3–5	Citations
date of the renaming	sources to start with	every answer shows its source

01 The renaming

On **16 July 2026** Google renamed NotebookLM as **Gemini Notebook**. It is the same product: the name changed, and notebooks you started in Gemini sync with the app.

IF YOU SEE NOTEBOOKLM IN A TUTORIAL

It is the same tool. Find the notebook under its current name and check the options in your account, since some features roll out in stages.

02 What makes it different from a chat

Only your sources

It answers from the documents you uploaded. If the information is not there, it says so.

Verifiable citations

Every claim carries a number that leads to the exact passage in the document.

Turns what you read into study material

Generates summaries, mind maps, study cards, quizzes and audio.

Study without invention

Ideal for reviewing your own material instead of relying on what the model remembers.

03 Create your first notebook

1. Sign in with your Google account and create a new notebook with a name that describes the topic.
2. Upload three to five quality sources: notes, a journal article, an official report.

3. Wait for the sources to be processed and review the summary the notebook proposes.

4. Ask one specific question and open a citation to check the original passage.



Upload your sources: the notebook only answers with what they contain.

04 Choosing good sources

Source quality sets answer quality. More sources do not always mean better results: a notebook with 50 messy documents answers worse than one with five well-chosen ones.

Good source	Weak source
An official report with date and author	Text with no author, no date and no references
A peer-reviewed journal article	An anonymous publication with no references
Your own notes, ordered by topic	Loose notes that contradict each other
Documents from the same period and topic	A mix of dates that changes the conclusion

05 Asking with citations

Answers include numbers in square brackets. Each number opens the passage in the document where the claim comes from.

- [ ] Open at least one citation for every important answer.
- [ ] If a claim has no citation, do not use it until you verify it.
- [ ] Ask for comparisons: “Where do these sources disagree?”

WORKING RULE

An answer without citations is a hypothesis. An answer with citations still needs your judgment: confirm that the passage says what the answer claims.

06 Study formats

Format	What it is for	How to ask for it
Summary	Understanding the main idea in minutes	“Summarize the sources in five ideas, each with its citation”
Mind map	Seeing the relationships between concepts	“Map the key concepts and how they relate”
Study cards	Memorizing terms and definitions	“Create 15 question-and-answer cards with citations”
Quiz	Checking what you understood	“Create 10 multiple-choice questions with explanations”

07 Audio Overviews: review by listening

Audio summaries turn your sources into a conversation between two voices. They are excellent for reviewing on the move. Use them as a first pass, not as a replacement for the critical sources: afterwards, open the citations you care about.



Listen first; then verify in the citations.

GETTING THE MOST OUT OF IT

Listen once without pausing, then write three ideas in your own words and compare them with the citations.

08 Analysis with code

Gemini Notebook can write and run code in a secure cloud environment to analyze your sources in more depth. This feature rolls out by plan: check your account to see whether it is available. Before using its results, verify the figures against a sample.

09 Curation and responsible use

Curating means choosing what goes into the notebook and how it is used. Before you share a generated summary:

- [ ] I checked the figures and citations against the original document.
- [ ] I did not include personal data about third parties or confidential information.
- [ ] I disclosed that the summary was generated with AI, where appropriate.



Curate as a team: review, cite and decide what enters the notebook.

In Colombia, if you work with personal data, see **Law 1581 of 2012**.

10 Worked example: preparing for an exam in 60 minutes

1. **Minutes 0–10:** upload your three main sources (notes, a chapter, an official guide) and ask for a summary of the central ideas with their citations.
2. **Minutes 10–25:** ask for a mind map of the concepts and how they relate. Check that every relationship has a citation.

3. **Minutes 25–40:** generate 15 study cards with citations. Study first the ones you get wrong.

4. **Minutes 40–60:** ask for a 10-question quiz with explanations and citations. Answer without looking, then review each error against the original citation.

A SIGN YOU STUDIED WELL

You can explain each concept without looking at your notes, and you can find the citation that supports it. If you cannot, go back to the source.

11 Practice plan

1. Create a notebook with three sources on a topic you are studying.
2. Ask five questions and verify one citation for each.
3. Generate a mind map and a set of study cards.
4. Listen to an Audio Overview and write three ideas in your own words.
5. Compare two sources and record where they contradict each other.

TO WRAP UP

- [ ] I use Gemini Notebook with a few high-quality, well-chosen sources.
- [ ] I verify citations before I use a claim.
- [ ] I turn material into study formats that make me recall it.
- [ ] I protect personal data and disclose AI use where appropriate.